

Applied Materials Inc. (AMAT): Stock should continue to re-rate given strong guidance uplift and improving mix – Buy

Key stock takeaways: We expect the stock to hold its gains following a strong quarter with guidance that came in above the Street, despite elevated investor expectations. We think management's guidance for over 30% growth (up from 20% just a quarter ago) for its semiconductor equipment business in CY26 cleared a relatively high bar, should bolster investor confidence in Applied's growth trajectory, and drive a re-rating for the stock relative to peers. We believe many of the investor misconceptions that weighed on the stock in CY25 (such as perceived market share loss in China) should reverse themselves in CY26 as Applied benefits from mix-related tailwinds tied to increased spending on foundry/logic, DRAM, and advanced packaging. We remain Buy rated on AMAT as we believe the company is positioned to outperform peers on a relative basis given its high relative exposure (over 60%) to deposition and etch, where we expect spending intensity to increase through 2027.

Read-through to our coverage: We expect a modestly positive reaction for LRCX (Buy), and to a lesser extent for KLAC (Neutral) in our coverage given similar end-market exposures, and the fact that these companies have already reported.

Quarterly results above the Street: Applied reported revenue of \$7.91 bn, above GS at \$7.86 bn and the Street at \$7.70 bn, while gross margin of 50.0% was well above GS at 49.4% and the Street at 49.3%. Non-GAAP EPS of \$2.86 was also above GS at \$2.77 and the Street at \$2.67. In Systems, DRAM revenue of \$1.73 bn was well below GS at \$2.10 bn and the Street at \$1.90 bn, NAND revenue of \$239 mn was below GS at \$247 mn and the Street at \$289 mn, and Foundry, Logic and Other revenue of \$4.00 bn was far above GS at \$3.51 bn and the Street at \$3.65 bn. Applied Global Services (AGS) revenue of \$1.67 bn was above GS at \$1.62 bn and the Street at \$1.61 bn.

- **2026 and long-term outlook:** Applied expects to grow its revenue in the context of a strongly growing WFE market in CY26, and the company expects its semiconductor equipment business to grow over 30% in 2026, which represents a meaningful increase relative to guidance of over 20% just last quarter. The company expects another strong WFE growth year in CY27, with growth likely to continue into CY28. Management continues to expect revenue to trend higher in 2H CY26 relative to 1H CY26, which is consistent with recent commentary from peers. The company believes it is better positioned to capture market growth in the coming year, as it sees the fastest growing market segments as leading-edge

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logic, DRAM, and advanced packaging, areas where Applied has stronger market share.

- **Gross margin and pricing:** Applied delivered gross margins of 50.0%, well above Street expectations. Going forward, the company guided gross margins to expand modestly in the coming quarters, particularly in light of lower China exposure in the current quarter. In terms of pricing, management expects any tailwinds to be gradual, as equipment is priced on a per-project basis over the course of two to three years – creating an opportunity for a long-term, gradual uplift to gross margins over the coming years.
- **Services:** Applied believes that as its installed equipment base grows, it can continue to accelerate its Services (AGS) business. Management now believes it can grow this business in the mid-teens range in the long run (up from low-double digits previously), and above this level in 2026.

Guidance is well above the Street. Applied guided 2Q well above the Street on revenue and margins. Revenue was guided to \$8.95 bn at the midpoint, which is well above GS at \$8.41 bn and the Street at \$8.20 bn. Semiconductor revenue is expected to be \$6.90 bn, with AGS revenue of \$1.75 bn and Other of \$300 mn. Gross margin is guided to 50.1%, which we expect to move modestly higher as shipment levels increase in 2H26. OpEx is expected to be \$1.485 bn, as the company is driving strategic R&D investments despite recent headcount optimization actions. The company expects a tax rate of 11%. Non-GAAP EPS guidance of \$3.16–\$3.56 (midpoint of \$3.36) is well above GS at \$3.05 and the Street at \$2.90.

Estimate changes. We increase our CY26–28 non-GAAP EPS estimates by an average of 23% to reflect higher revenue and margin assumptions (see detailed estimates below — [Exhibit 3](#)).

Price target. We raise our price target to \$520 (from \$390), which is based on a 32X P/E multiple (up from 30X given better visibility) applied to our normalized EPS estimate of \$16.10 (up from \$13.00 due to higher revenue and gross margin assumptions). Key downside risks include: (1) incremental export restrictions; (2) local China-based supplier share gains.

We remain Buy rated on AMAT. We expect Applied to outperform peers given outsized exposure to deposition and etch, which should outperform on a relative basis given incremental spending on GAA logic and stacked memory structures. Additionally, we remain positive on the company's portfolio of critical equipment tools, with roughly 30% of systems revenue currently generated from integrated solutions.

Exhibit 1: AMAT - Variance summary

Financials (\$ mn, except EPS)	1Q26				
	Actual	GS	Street	Actual/GS	Actual/Street
DRAM	1,730	2,098	1,898	-17.5%	-8.9%
NAND	239	247	289	-3.3%	-17.5%
Foundry, Logic and Other	3,997	3,506	3,651	14.0%	9.5%
Applied Global Services (AGS)	1,665	1,621	1,608	2.7%	3.5%
Display	280	390	230	-28.2%	21.9%
Total Revenue	7,910	7,862	7,703	0.6%	2.7%
QoQ	12.8%	12.1%	9.9%		
YoY	11.4%	10.7%	8.5%		
Gross Margin	50.0%	49.4%	49.3%	+60 bps	+68 bps
Operating Margin	32.1%	31.3%	30.9%	+76 bps	+119 bps
Non-GAAP EPS	\$2.86	\$2.77	\$2.67	3.2%	7.2%

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research, Visible Alpha Consensus Data

Exhibit 2: AMAT - Guidance summary

Financials (\$ mn, except EPS)	2Q26E						
	High	Low	Guidance (midpoint)	GS	Street	Guidance/GS	Guidance/Street
Total Revenue	9,450	8,450	8,950	8,412	8,196	6.4%	9.2%
QoQ			13.1%	7.0%	3.6%		
YoY			22.6%	15.2%	12.2%		
Gross Margin	50.1%	50.1%	50.1%	49.6%	49.5%	+46 bps	+60 bps
Non-GAAP EPS	\$3.56	\$3.16	\$3.36	\$3.05	\$2.90	10.1%	15.7%

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research, Visible Alpha Consensus Data

Exhibit 3: AMAT - Old vs. New CY estimates

Financials (\$mn, except EPS)	CY26E			CY27E			CY28E		
	GS	Old	Δ	GS	Old	Δ	GS	Old	Δ
Revenue	36,806	34,076	+8.0%	45,972	39,122	+17.5%	51,572	43,034	+19.8%
YoY	30.5%			24.9%			12.2%		
Gross Margin	50.3%	49.7%	+67 bps	50.5%	49.9%	+57 bps	50.7%	49.9%	+79 bps
Operating Margin	33.9%	32.2%	+171 bps	35.2%	32.8%	+238 bps	36.1%	33.5%	+254 bps
Non-GAAP EPS	\$14.15	\$12.35	+14.6%	\$18.55	\$14.70	+26.2%	\$21.50	\$16.80	+28.0%

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 4: Price target

PRICE TARGET AND RISK/REWARD SUMMARY				
Method	Metric	Base	Bull	Bear
P/E Method	Normalized EPS Estimate	\$16.10	\$18.52	\$13.69
	Multiple	32.0x	31.0x	18.0x
	Valuation	\$520.00	\$574.00	\$246.00
	Upside/Downside	18.2%	30.5%	-44.1%
Price Target	12-Month Price Target	\$520.00	100% P/E	
	Potential Upside/Downside	18.2%		
	Dividend Yield at Current Price	0.4%		
	Potential Total Return	18.6%		

Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

AMAT	12m Price Target: \$520.00	Price: \$440.56	Upside: 18.0%			
Buy	GS Forecast					
	Market cap: \$352.0bn Enterprise value: \$351.8bn 3m ADTV: \$2.5bn United States Americas Semiconductors, Telecom & IT Services M&A Rank: 3		10/25	10/26E	10/27E	10/28E
		Revenue (\$ mn) New	28,368.0	33,741.6	43,715.9	50,665.1
		Revenue (\$ mn) Old	28,368.0	31,972.7	37,850.4	42,388.8
		EBITDA (\$ mn)	8,997.0	11,604.7	15,707.5	18,590.6
		EBIT (\$ mn)	8,562.0	11,122.7	15,267.5	18,150.6
		EPS (\$ New)	9.42	12.57	17.45	20.93
		EPS (\$ Old)	9.42	11.35	14.10	16.38
		P/E (X)	18.6	35.0	25.2	21.0
		Dividend yield (%)	1.0	0.4	0.5	0.6
		Net debt/EBITDA (X)	(0.1)	(0.0)	(0.2)	(0.5)
			4/26	7/26E	10/26E	1/27E
EPS (\$)	2.86	3.56	3.78	3.95		

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates, FactSet. Price as of 14 May 2026 close.

Disclosure Appendix

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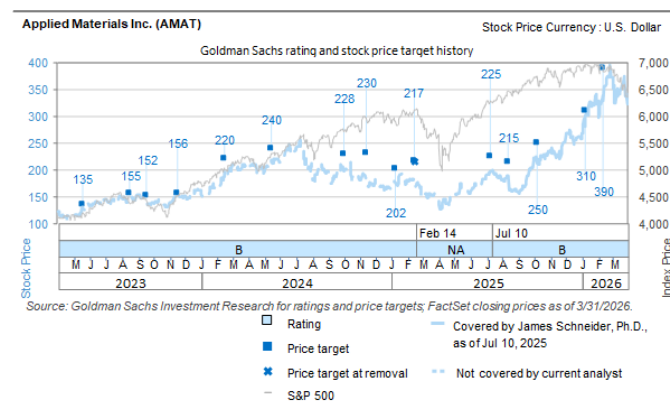
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Applied Materials Inc. (AMAT)

Date of report	Target price (\$)	Closing price (\$)
13-Feb-26	390.00	354.91
09-Jan-26	310.00	301.18
08-Oct-25	250.00	217.51
15-Aug-25	215.00	161.76
10-Jul-25	225.00	198.03
10-Jan-25	202.00	171.65
15-Nov-24	230.00	168.88
02-Oct-24	228.00	201.15
17-May-24	240.00	212.08
16-Feb-24	220.00	199.57
17-Nov-23	156.00	148.59
19-Sep-23	152.00	137.71
18-Aug-23	155.00	142.66
19-May-23	135.00	126.95

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